



AI confused by humans

AI algorithms are puzzled by humanity's behaviour online during the coronavirus pandemic. <https://dgit.in/jun20-46>



Fitbit Ventilators?

Fitbit is reportedly planning on building ventilators to help with the COVID-19 situation. <https://dgit.in/jun20-47>

cal climate delicately while keeping the audience intrigued towards the primary plot.

Bong uses black comedy as a medium to shift tones constantly. As mentioned earlier, doing this allows the director to loosen up the tension a little and then hit the audience harder with the following consequence. Other than using black comedy to achieve this, Bong also uses slapstick humour to initiate laughter. These include action sequences involving dropkicks in his murder mystery films *Memories of Murder* and *Mother*. And the scene in *Parasite* where one of the characters kicks another character down the stairs. As an audience member, you let out a sudden outburst of laughter. But, 2 seconds later you regret it, seeing the consequence. The character who got kicked down hits their head hard onto a concrete wall and starts oozing out blood. This sort of tone shift makes the audience question their humanity. Was seeing someone getting injured funny? Does laughing at that particular scene make them a bad person? Using these techniques Bong Joon-ho manages to play with the audience's minds and use them as a guinea pig to quench his thirst for filmmaking.



HIDEO KOJIMA

Soon after Hideo Kojima's departure from KONA-MI, he announced his own videogame company – Kojima Productions.

Later on, he announced his first game as an independent creator to be published by Sony Interactive – *Death Stranding*. When the trailer came out, people were intrigued by the visuals. No one had any idea as to what the game was going to be about or what genre it belonged to. It looked like a mixture of a horror and action game. Long before the creation of Kojima Productions, Kojima was known for his *Metal Gear* games and the introduction of the stealth

genre. This marked an important milestone in the videogame industry. Years later, in 2019, Hideo revealed that his plan with *Death Stranding* was to invent yet another new genre – Strand Games.

Hideo Kojima's *Death Stranding* provided a completely new experience for gamers worldwide. The idea of introducing multi-player mechanics for fans of single-player games was a step away from the general norms of videogame creation. But, that was not enough for gamers. The gameplay element of *Death Stranding* was pretty dull and dragging, and it was criticized for it. However, the story elements received a lot of praise. As weird as it sounds, the cutscenes and some parts of the gameplay were the most entertaining aspects of the game. The base gameplay genre for *Death Stranding* was tagged as a walking simulator or a Strand game. Kojima's ideology with the game was to send out an underlying political message which was that there was a lot of disconnect amongst the human race. The player had to carry cargo from one destination to the other, thereby establishing a connection via strands, which eventually unfolds the story. Other than that, there were occasional boss fights which could be avoided as long as the player was careful with their movements. Avoiding these boss fights involved holding the breath and moving extremely cautiously so as to not alert the BTs. This initiates a feeling of horror and stealth to a certain level.

As mentioned earlier, the story was the strongest point in the game. This is not surprising considering that Kojima understands filmmaking to an admirable extent. As he describes himself, "70 percent of my body is made of movies." Kojima introduces the player into a post-apocalyptic world. This creates a

feeling of loneliness and solitude, which is reflected on the player. This further forces the desperate player to connect and interact with people in the game. Despite the base story genre being science fiction, the game also introduces elements of horror and religion throughout. With respect to science fiction, it explores ideas of the big bang explosion, mass-extinction, time-travel and teleportation. With respect to horror, it induces creeping fear within the player by keeping the BTs invisible, with loud and visible footsteps trampling along on wet mud. Along with that, Clifford Unger's undying skull soldiers also added to an element of



A still from *Death Stranding*

fear within the game. Religion-wise the game explores the idea of the afterlife by constantly switching between the world of the living and the dead (in this case, *The Beach*). Using these genre-bending and creation techniques Hideo Kojima manages to tell a mind-bending tale while also opening up a pathway for a wide array of experimentation with respect to newer forms of gameplay.

Genre-bending is a delicate procedure. Lack of knowledge on the subject could lead to a film being a complete disaster with loose ends and a messy, out of structure storyline. This leads to misinterpretation and confusion amongst the audience. But, under someone with the right amount of experience, attention to detail and vision, genre-bending could do wonders for their storytelling and make their work stand out within the filmmaking industry. 